

MGT2

IT Project Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A regional hospital's sponsor has just approved a business case for a new patient-portal project with an expected budget of \$1.2 million. The hospital's last portal vendor went out of business in 2023. The sponsor now wants to formally authorize the project and give the chosen project manager authority to use resources. Which document is created next?

- A. A vendor contract, because the last vendor failed.
- B. The project charter, in the Initiating process group.
- C. The project management plan, in the Planning process group.
- D. The work breakdown structure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Midway through an ERP rollout at a furniture maker, a vice president asks a developer directly to add a custom sales report. The developer says it will take only two days, and the project is running 5% under budget. The project uses a formal change control board. What should the project manager do?

- A. Refuse the request, because no changes are allowed after the baseline is set.
- B. Let the developer add it, since the project is under budget.
- C. Add the report now and update the baseline afterward.
- D. Log the request, analyze its impact on scope, schedule, cost and quality, and send it to the change control board.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A network upgrade has four activities. A (3 days) starts the project. B (4 days) and C (6 days) both follow A and can run at the same time. D (2 days) starts after both B and C finish. Activity B is assigned to the team's most senior engineer. What is the shortest time in which the project can finish?

- A. 9 days
- B. 11 days
- C. 6 days
- D. 15 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A data-center migration has a budget at completion of \$500,000. At the end of month four, planned value is \$200,000, earned value is \$180,000 and actual cost is \$225,000. The sponsor praised the team at the last steering meeting. What is the cost performance index, and what does it mean?

- A. 0.80; the project is over budget.
- B. 1.25; the project is under budget.
- C. 0.89; the project is over budget.
- D. 0.90; the project is behind schedule.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project's schedule performance index is 1.10 and its earned value is \$330,000. What is its planned value?

- A. It cannot be found without actual cost.
- B. \$330,000
- C. \$363,000
- D. \$300,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A CRM implementation has a budget at completion of \$800,000 and a cost performance index of 0.80. The team uses a hybrid agile approach and its main vendor is based in Ireland. If current cost performance continues, what is the estimate at completion?

- A. \$800,000
- B. \$200,000
- C. \$640,000
- D. \$1,000,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project's estimate at completion is \$1,200,000, based on a cost performance index of 0.75 that is expected to continue. What was the budget at completion?

- A.** \$1,600,000
- B.** \$300,000
- C.** \$900,000
- D.** \$1,200,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

On a payroll-system replacement, the CFO can cancel the project's funding at any time but has skipped all three status meetings and rarely reads updates. The CFO joined the company from a retail chain last year. On a power/interest grid, how should the project manager treat the CFO?

- A.** Keep satisfied.
- B.** Manage closely.
- C.** Keep informed.
- D.** Monitor with minimum effort.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A project team at a credit union planned to use a brand-new database product that none of its twelve developers has used. The vendor's sales rep is known for quick replies. To remove the risk of delays from learning the new tool, the project manager switches to the database the team already knows well. Which risk response is this?

- A.** Transfer.
- B.** Avoid.
- C.** Mitigate.
- D.** Accept.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project manager decides to mitigate a threat that defects will reach production. Which action fits that choice?

- A.** Buy a warranty so a vendor pays for any defect fixes.
- B.** Note the risk and deal with defects only if they occur.
- C.** Add an extra round of automated testing before each release.
- D.** Remove the risky feature from scope entirely.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A software team of 8 people, including the project manager, is split between offices in Denver and Pune and holds a video stand-up every weekday. How many communication channels does the team have?

- A.** 28
- B.** 56
- C.** 2
- D.** 8

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project team grows from 6 people to 10 people. How many communication channels are added?

- A.** 45
- B.** 4
- C.** 30
- D.** 6

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A regional hospital's sponsor has just approved a business case for a new patient-portal project ~~with an expected budget of \$1.2 million. The hospital's last portal vendor went out of business in 2023.~~ The sponsor now wants to formally authorize the project and give the chosen project manager authority to use resources. Which document is created next?

Target word: document that authorizes the project **Decides:** Formal authorization and naming the PM happen in the charter.

A	Camouflage	Answers the vendor history; procurement comes after authorization and planning.
B	Correct	The charter authorizes the project and gives the PM authority to apply resources.
C	Adjacent category	The plan is built after the project is authorized.
D	Confusion set	The WBS decomposes scope during planning; it does not authorize anything.

2. Answer D Concept 2

Midway through an ERP rollout ~~at a furniture maker,~~ a vice president asks a developer directly to add a custom sales report. The developer says it will take only two days, ~~and the project is running 5% under budget.~~ The project uses a formal change control board. What should the project manager do?

Target word: correct handling of a change request **Decides:** A formal change control process exists and applies to every change.

A	Absolute language	Changes are allowed; they must go through the process.
B	Camouflage	Budget slack does not bypass change control.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the order: approval comes before the work and the baseline change.
D	Correct	Integrated change control documents and assesses a change before approval.

3. Answer B Concept 3

A network upgrade has four activities. A (3 days) starts the project. B (4 days) and C (6 days) both follow A and can run at the same time. D (2 days) starts after both B and C finish. ~~Activity B is assigned to the team's most senior engineer.~~ What is the shortest time in which the project can finish?

Target word: project duration **Decides:** The longer path A-C-D sets the duration.

A	Inverted operation	Uses the shortest path; D cannot start until C is done.
B	Correct	A-B-D = 9 days; A-C-D = 3 + 6 + 2 = 11 days. The longest path is critical.
C	Wrong stem number	The duration of C alone.
D	Dropped element	Adds every activity, dropping the fact that B and C run in parallel.

4. Answer A Concept 4

A data-center migration has a budget at completion of \$500,000. At the end of month four, planned value is \$200,000, earned value is \$180,000 and actual cost is \$225,000. ~~The sponsor praised the team at the last steering meeting.~~ What is the cost performance index, and what does it mean?

Target word: CPI and its meaning **Decides:** $CPI = EV / AC$.

A	Correct	$\$180,000 / \$225,000 = 0.80$; each dollar spent earns 80 cents of work.
B	Inverted operation	AC / EV flips the ratio.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses PV ($\$200,000 / \$225,000$) instead of EV.
D	Confusion set	$EV / PV = 0.90$ is the SPI, a schedule measure.

5. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A project's schedule performance index is 1.10 and its earned value is \$330,000. What is its planned value?

Target word: solve for PV **Decides:** $SPI = EV / PV$, so $PV = EV / SPI$.

A	Confusion set	Actual cost is needed for CPI, not SPI.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the earned value.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies EV by SPI instead of dividing.
D	Correct	$\$330,000 / 1.10 = \$300,000$.

6. Answer D Concept 5

A CRM implementation has a budget at completion of \$800,000 and a cost performance index of 0.80. ~~The team uses a hybrid agile approach and its main vendor is based in Ireland.~~ If current cost performance continues, what is the estimate at completion?

Target word: EAC **Decides:** $EAC = BAC / CPI$ when performance continues.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out the CPI; that is the original budget.
B	Adjacent category	That is the variance at completion, not the total forecast.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies BAC by CPI; a CPI below 1 must raise the forecast.
D	Correct	$\$800,000 / 0.80 = \$1,000,000$.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A project's estimate at completion is \$1,200,000, based on a cost performance index of 0.75 that is expected to continue. What was the budget at completion?

Target word: solve for BAC **Decides:** $EAC = BAC / CPI$, so $BAC = EAC \times CPI$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides EAC by CPI again.
B	Adjacent category	That is the variance at completion.
C	Correct	$\$1,200,000 \times 0.75 = \$900,000$.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the EAC.

8. Answer A Concept 6

On a payroll-system replacement, the CFO can cancel the project's funding at any time but has skipped all three status meetings and rarely reads updates. ~~The CFO joined the company from a retail chain last year.~~ On a power/interest grid, how should the project manager treat the CFO?

Target word: grid strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Correct	High power and low interest: meet their needs without over-communicating.
B	Adjacent category	Reserved for high power and high interest.
C	Inverted operation	Fits the opposite quadrant: low power, high interest.
D	Dropped element	Drops the CFO's power; minimum effort fits low power and low interest.

9. Answer B Concept 7

A project team ~~at a credit union~~ planned to use a brand-new database product that none of its twelve developers has used. ~~The vendor's sales rep is known for quick replies.~~ To remove the risk of delays from learning the new tool, the project manager switches to the database the team already knows well. Which risk response is this?

Target word: risk response type **Decides:** The plan was changed so the threat no longer exists.

A	Confusion set	Transfer shifts impact to a third party, such as an insurer or vendor.
B	Correct	Changing the plan to eliminate the threat is avoidance.
C	Adjacent category	Mitigation lowers probability or impact; here the threat is removed entirely.
D	Inverted operation	Acceptance leaves the plan unchanged; the PM changed it.

10. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A project manager decides to mitigate a threat that defects will reach production. Which action fits that choice?

Target word: action that is mitigation **Decides:** Mitigation reduces probability or impact without removing the threat.

A	Confusion set	Shifting the financial impact is transfer.
B	Inverted operation	That is passive acceptance.
C	Correct	Lowers the probability of defects reaching production.
D	Adjacent category	Eliminating the threat is avoidance.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A software team of 8 people, including the project manager, ~~is split between offices in Denver and Pune and holds a video stand-up every weekday.~~ How many communication channels does the team have?

Target word: number of channels **Decides:** $n = 8$ people; channels = $n(n - 1) / 2$.

A	Correct	$8 \times 7 / 2 = 28$.
B	Dropped element	8×7 without dividing by 2 counts each channel twice.
C	Camouflage	Counts offices; location does not decide channels.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the number of people, not channels.

12. Answer C Concept 8 · transfer

A project team grows from 6 people to 10 people. How many communication channels are added?

Target word: increase in channels **Decides:** $10 \times 9 / 2 = 45$ minus $6 \times 5 / 2 = 15$.

A	Dropped element	The new total, without subtracting the original 15.
B	Wrong stem number	The number of people added.
C	Correct	$45 - 15 = 30$ new channels.
D	Adjacent category	Counts only channels among the four new people ($4 \times 3 / 2$).

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	6	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	1	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Process groups and the charter	The project charter formally authorizes the project and names the project manager in the Initiating process group; detailed plans come later in Planning.	Jumping to the project management plan or WBS before the project is authorized.	“Formally authorize,” “name the project manager,” or a sponsor approving a business case.
2	Integrated change control	Every change request is documented, assessed for impact on scope, time, cost and quality, and approved or rejected before work begins.	Letting a small or affordable change go straight into the work.	A stakeholder asks a team member directly for “just a small” addition.
3	Critical path	The critical path is the longest path through the network; it sets the shortest possible project duration and its activities have zero float.	Picking the shortest path or adding every activity together.	Parallel paths with durations that must be compared.
4	Earned value indices	$CPI = EV / AC$ and $SPI = EV / PV$; below 1.0 means over budget or behind schedule.	Dividing in the wrong order or using PV for cost performance.	PV, EV and AC given together.
5	Estimate at completion	If current cost performance continues, $EAC = BAC / CPI$.	Multiplying BAC by CPI.	“If current performance continues” with a BAC and a CPI.
6	Power/interest grid	High power and high interest: manage closely; high power, low interest: keep satisfied; low power, high interest: keep informed; low and low: monitor.	Ignoring a powerful stakeholder because they show little interest.	A stakeholder's authority and level of engagement described together.
7	Negative risk responses	Avoid removes the threat, transfer shifts its impact to a third party, mitigate lowers its probability or impact, accept acknowledges it without changing the plan.	Calling any action that reduces risk “avoid.”	What happens to the threat: gone, shifted, smaller, or left in place.
8	Communication channels	$Channels = n(n - 1) / 2$, where n is the number of people.	Forgetting to divide by two, or counting people instead of channels.	A team size and a question about communication paths.

Course scope (public description): IT Project Management provides an overview of the Project Management Institute’s project management methodology. Topics cover various process groups and knowledge areas and application of knowledge in case studies for planning a project that has not started yet and monitoring/controlling a project that is already underway.